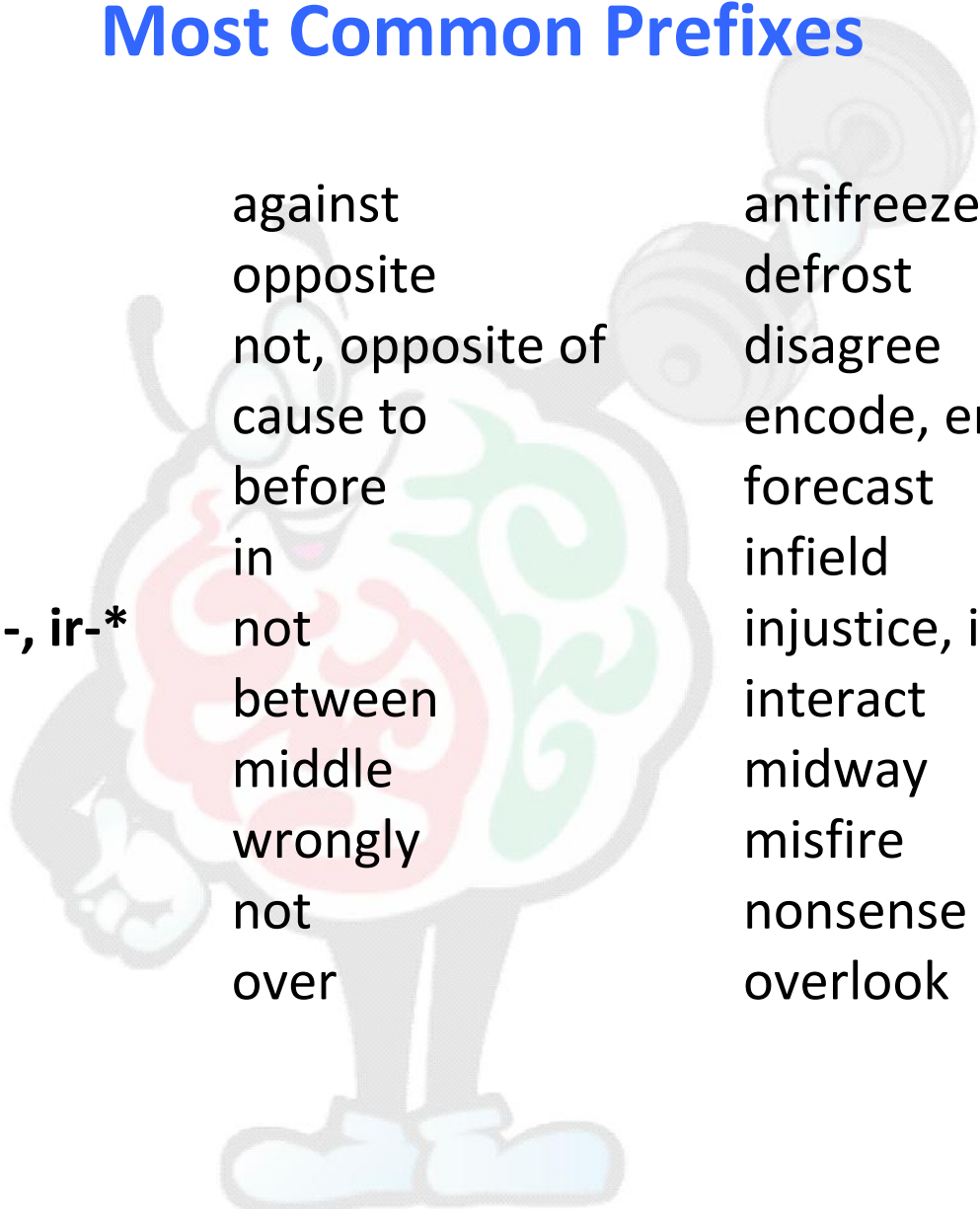




COMMONLY USED AFFIXES **(ENGLISH)**

Most Common Prefixes



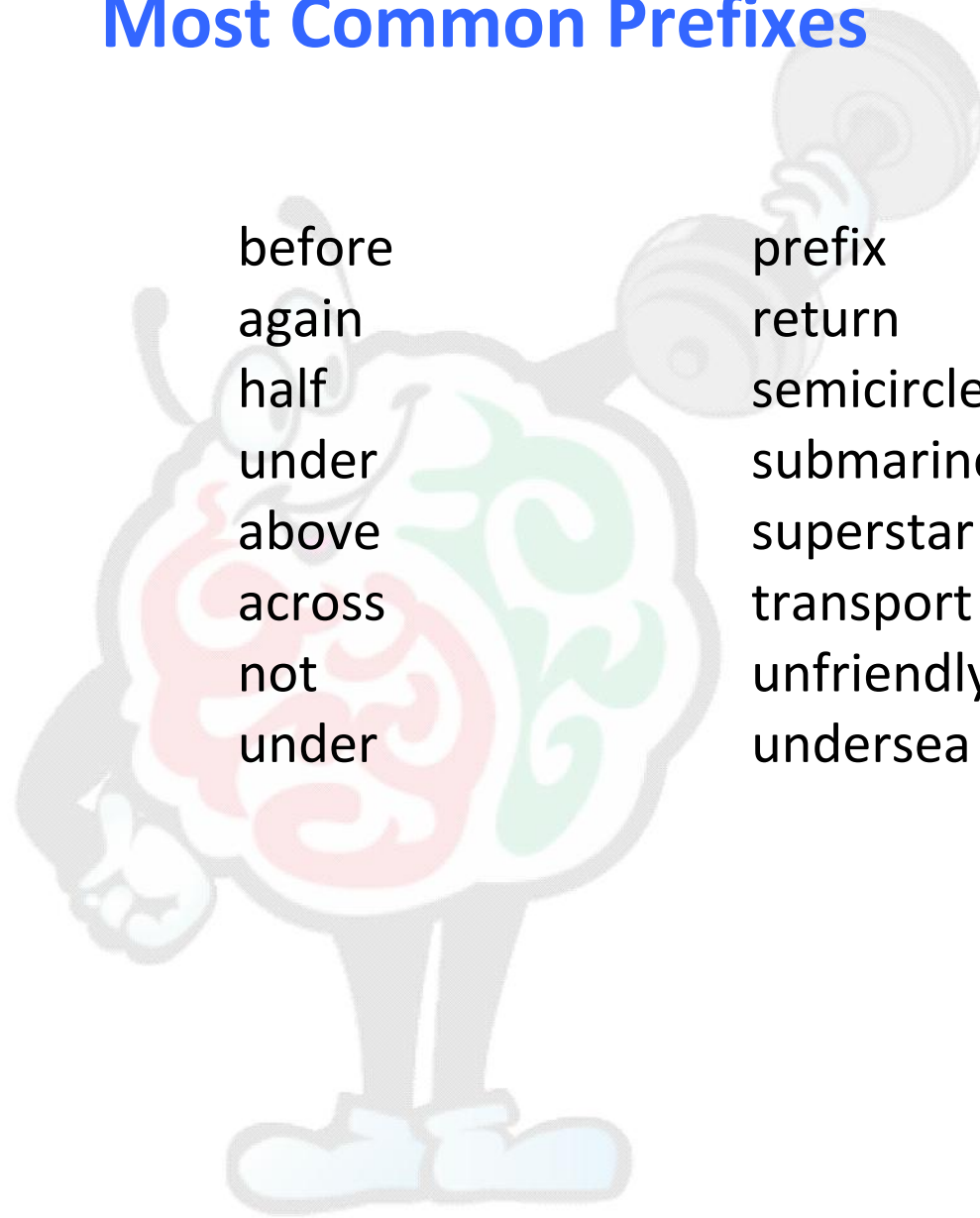
anti-	against	antifreeze
de-	opposite	defrost
dis-*	not, opposite of	disagree
en-, em-	cause to	encode, embrace
fore-	before	forecast
in-, im-	in	infield
in-, im-, il-, ir-*	not	injustice, impossible
inter-	between	interact
mid-	middle	midway
mis-	wrongly	misfire
non-	not	nonsense
over-	over	overlook

Most Common Prefixes

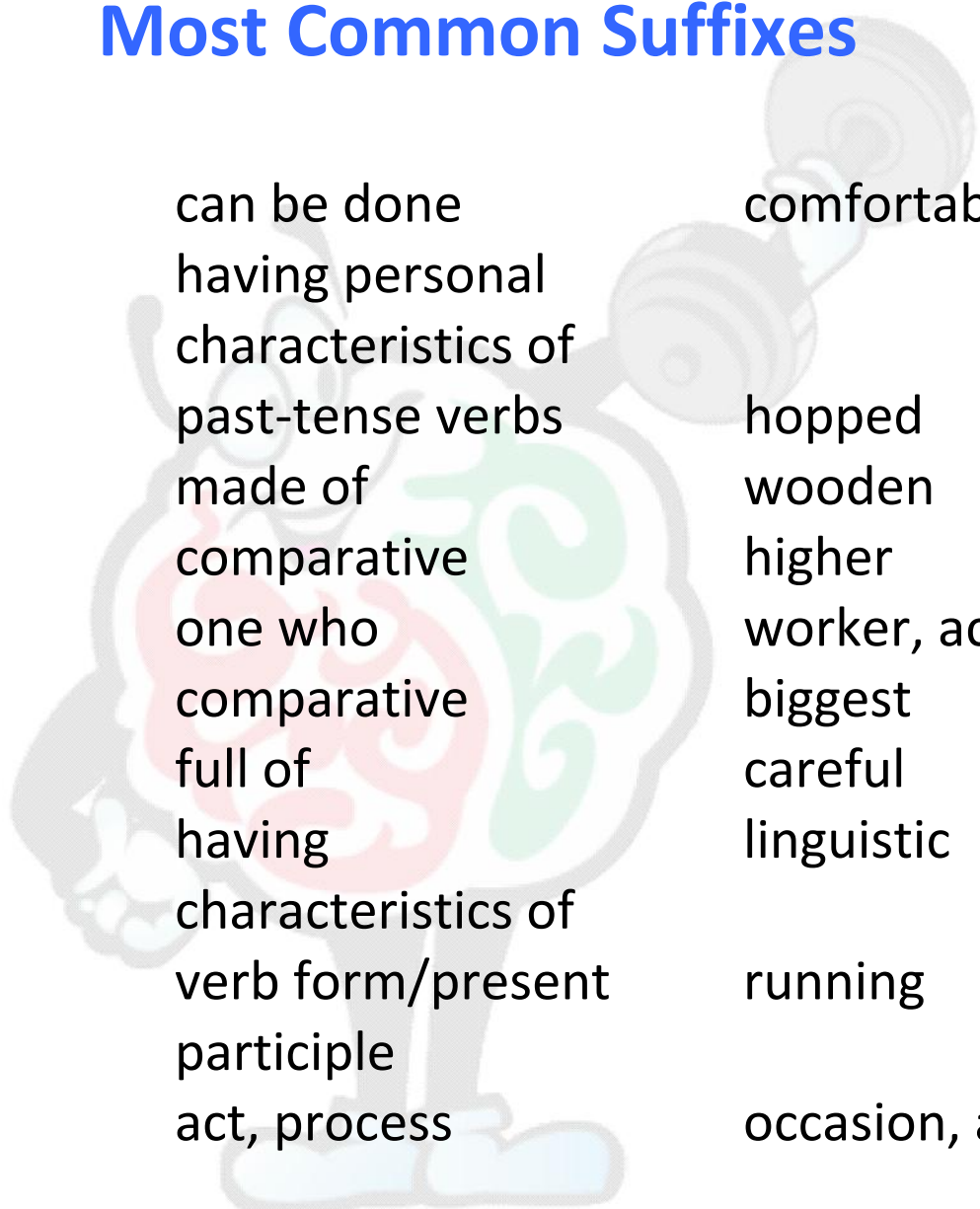
pre-
re-*
semi-
sub-
super-
trans-
un-*
under-

before
again
half
under
above
across
not
under

prefix
return
semicircle
submarine
superstar
transport
unfriendly
undersea



Most Common Suffixes



-able, -ible	can be done	comfortable
-al, -ial	having personal characteristics of	
-ed*	past-tense verbs	hopped
-en	made of	wooden
-er	comparative	higher
-er,	one who	worker, actor
-est	comparative	biggest
-ful	full of	careful
-ic	having characteristics of	linguistic
-ing*	verb form/present participle	running
-ion, -tion, -ation, ition	act, process	occasion, attraction

Most Common Suffixes



-ity, -ty	state of	infinity
-ive, -ative, -itive	adjective form of a noun	plaintive
-less	without	fearless
-ly*	characteristic of	quickly
-ment	action or process	enjoyment
-ness	state of, condition of	kindness
-ous, -eous, -ious	possessing the qualities of	joyous
-s, -es*	more than one	books, boxes
-y	characterized by	happy

*Most frequent. The four most frequent suffixes account for 97 percent of prefixed/suffixed words in printed school English.

Source: *Teaching Reading Sourcebook: For Kindergarten Through Eighth Grade* by Bill Honig, Linda Diamond, and Linda Gutlohn. © 2000

Common Word Roots

ROOT	MEANING	EXAMPLES
-ast(er)-(G)	star	asteroid, astronomy
-audi- (L)	hear	audible, audience
-auto- (G)	self	automatic, autopsy
-bene- (L)	good	benefit, benign
-bio- (G)	life	biography, biology
-chrono- (G)	time	chronic, synchronize
-dict- (L)	say	dictate, diction
-duc- (L)	lead, make	deduce, produce
-gen- (L)	give birth	gene, generate
-geo- (G)	earth	geography, geology

Common Word Roots

-graph- (G)	write	autograph, graph
-jur-, -jus- (L)	law	jury, justice
-log-, -logue- (L)	thought	logic, obloquy
-luc- (L)	light	lucid, translucent
-man(u)- (L)	hand	manual, manure
-mand-, -mend- (L)	order	demand, recommend
-mis-, -mit- (L)	send	missile, transmission
-omni- (L)	all	omnivorous
-path- (G)	feel	empathy, pathetic
-phil- (G)	love	philosophy, bibliophile

Common Word Roots

-phon- (G)	sound	phonics, telephone
-photo- (G)	light	photograph, photon
-port- (L)	carry	export, portable
-qui(t)- (L)	quiet, rest	acquit, tranquil
-scrib-, -script- (L)	write	ascribe, script
-sens-, -sent- (L)	feel	resent, sensitive
-tele- (G)	far off	telecast, telephone
-terr- (L)	earth	terrain, territory
-vac- (L)	empty	evacuate, vacate
-vid-, -vis- (L)	see	visible, video

Source: <http://grammar.about.com/od/words/a/wordroots.htm>. Retrieved 18 July 2010

Common Verbal Relationships

CATEGORY	RELATIONSHIP	EXAMPLE
Synonym-Antonym	Means the same as (opposite of)	Infinite: Limitless
Classification/Characteristic	Is a type of, An adjective describing one part of	Screwdriver: Tool Dirty: Garbage
Part-Whole/Specific-General	Is a part of	Fur: Bear
Sequence	Usually becomes (comes before)	Caterpillar: Butterfly
Cause and Effect	Is a cause/effect of	Procrastination: Cramming

Common Verbal Relationships

CATEGORY	RELATIONSHIP	EXAMPLE
Complement	Usually goes with	Cup: Saucer
Function, Purpose	Is used to, done by	Shovel: dig
Tool/Instrument: User: Object of action	Is used by... as a tool. Acts on/upon	Ruler: architect Rolling pin: dough
Composition	Is made from (of)	Dough: Cake
Degree of difference	Is a larger/smaller version of	Tugboat: Yacht
Intensity, Quantity, Amount	Is more/less than	Drizzle: Typhoon
Measure	Is a measure of	Kilogram: mass

Common Verbal Relationships

CATEGORY	RELATIONSHIP	EXAMPLE
Shape, Color, Smell, etc.	Is in the form, shape, texture, etc.	Chessboard: Square
Position/Location	Is located near or around	Quezon City: Metro Manila
Worker: Product	Profession and product	Architects: building
Worker: Action	What the worker does	Doctor: Cures
Worker: Workplace	Location of practice	Dentist: Clinic
Worker: Tool	The tool that the worker uses	Canvas: Painter

Common Verbal Relationships

CATEGORY	RELATIONSHIP	EXAMPLE
Action: Significance	Implication of the action	Kneel: Respect
Symbolism	Symbol and meaning	Heart: Love
Grammatical/Verbal	Parallelism in form	She: hers :: he: his